SCREEN-04 | Therapist only - all age groups

Alternative ways to meet a need

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Expand options for meeting a need served by digital use without erasing its contribution. Choose one available alternative and explore whether it fits a real context.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

There is no blanket screen ban, uniform time limit, or withdrawal of connection and accessibility tools. Do not force social, physical, or spiritual activity. Loneliness, distress, or ongoing difficulty needs tailored support beyond a list of alternatives.

Reusing existing material

SCREEN-02 identifies the need. Here, develop another option; MEANING and REG can help choose a direction or emotional response according to need.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Roy uses videos to pass waiting time. He chooses to also try listening to content that interests him or having a short conversation, without deciding he must stop videos entirely.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What need would we like to have more than one way to meet?

2 | Question for discussion

What digital and other options are available to me?

3 | Question for discussion

What practical barriers does each option involve?

4 | Question for discussion

What small trial can be undertaken by agreement?

5 | Question for discussion

How will we assess fit without measuring success by avoidance?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If no alternative is available, explore the barrier and needed support instead of blaming lack of motivation. Digital use may currently be the most suitable response.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

An adult offers a few available options, not a list of things the child must do. Do not present screens as a reward or the alternative as punishment.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Respect meaningful digital relationships and living conditions. An alternative does not require leaving home, spending money, or contacting a friend.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Consider time, accessibility, caregiving, and work demands. The aim is to expand options, not define digital use as a less worthy activity.

OA | Older adults

Allow familiar activity, remote connection, and choosing quiet. Do not force meetings or movement based on assumptions about loneliness or reduced functioning.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose one small, voluntary trial that can be stopped. There is no target to reduce minutes or requirement to remove the device; comparing options in conversation alone is possible.

At the next session

Explore fit with the need, accessibility, and willingness to continue. Choosing not to keep an alternative is also useful learning, not failure.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.unicef.org/eca/10-ways-create-healthy-digital-habits-home
www.unicef.org/parenting/child-care/supporting-child-negative-online-experience

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